

Spain

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** July 19, 1927 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red and yellow are the colors of the arms of both Castille and Aragón



The first red and yellow flag of Spain was adopted in the 18th century for use at sea

The present layout was adopted in 1927

Europe



Spain was united in the 15th century and rapidly became an imperial power. It lost most of its colonies during the 19th century.

Early Spanish flags were mostly heraldic; some, like the flag of Castilla y León (*see page 138*) survive today.

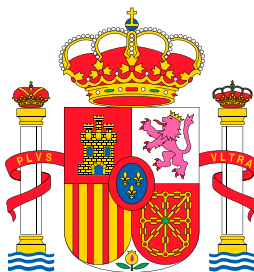
In 1785 the King of Spain adopted red and yellow, a combination of colors then used by no other country, to distinguish Spanish ships. The present pattern was finally established in 1927.

THE SPANISH REPUBLIC

When Spain became a republic in 1931, an equal horizontal tricolor in red, yellow, and purple became the new flag. Purple was from the arms of León. At the end of the Spanish Civil War (1936-1939) the original flag was restored.

The state flag has the national arms set toward the hoist.

ARMS OF SPAIN



The arms show the regions of Spain. The shield is supported by the Pillars of Hercules and has the Spanish royal crown above.